

HTML5: INTEL XDK

The mobile industry has, for the past few years, witnessed rampant growth with the evolution of platforms such as Android and iOS. This has also resulted in better choice for the consumer. What's more, each and every major mobile phone manufacturer has tried to float its own mobile platform in the market at some point of time, be it Nokia's Symbian or Samsung's bada. Many such platforms have come and gone, but only a few have managed to survive the tide of time. While this trend does result in more choice to the consumer, at some point it also results in a bit of confusion as to whether the future of the platform is secure and whether it would make sense to invest in a technology that is just coming up and has a future that is very uncertain.

CHALLENGES POSED...

This problem can also be similarly extrapolated and examined from the point of view of developers, brands and those intending to target these consumers with availability of content in the form of mobile apps. In recent times, the number of apps has primarily been the most important measure of success for a particular platform related to mobile devices. This is the reason why platform owners have been continuously trying to lure developers into their own ecosystem with exciting rewards along with a promise of big returns in app monetisation, a practice that was never as much prevalent before.

This however, presents a problem to the developers who are as much confused about putting in their time and effort as they are worried about the possible monetisation possibilities on these platforms. While there are now newer monetization channels available – whether they are in the form of in-app pur-

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chases or some content made available in the form of a subscription model, the problem of a learning curve attached to each new API and a new platform is a bigger issue than it is normally perceived. Not that it is something which is technically complex or incomprehensible, but the fact that it takes time, effort and possibly a finite amount of resources every time a new platform or API is released or even when an existing one is updated, becomes a deterrent in itself. What's more, if a hugely touted future mobile platform is going to be released, developers always need to be ahead of the times and start planning for the future possibilities before it even reaches the market. This essentially means that a lot of resources already have

